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OLDER ISSUES





If I understood it at all, then it was interesting.



El sexo esta sobrevalorado
Me voy a cortar el pico

Si, yo soy asi
No es por culpa de la droga
Si, yo soy asi
No es por culpa del alkohol





Loco me llaman porque bailo punk rock
Porque soy loco, loco de remate
Y siempre deberer bailar, tomar, y gosar

I love living in the City

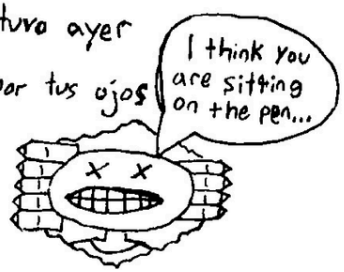
Se me pudre la mente
en la depresion
Soy un esclavo
a la depresion

Aburrimiento
No hay nada ke hacer
Aburrimiento
Otra dia sin placer

The Kids of the Coca Cola Nation
are too doped up to realize
that time is running out

No tenemos ninguna propuesta
Y no tenemos porque tenerlas

Dia tras dia, sin saber ke hacer
Vuelvas a la cama, donde estuvo ayer
Sabes que estas solo, solo por tus ojos



Watch out, it's your future - SHADY

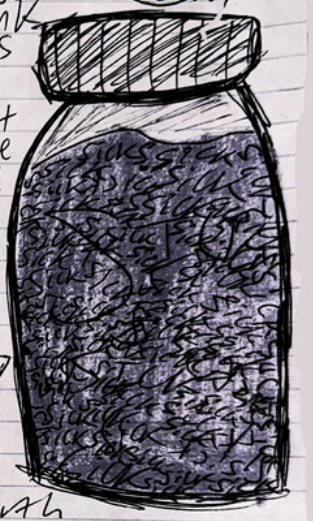
(I'M) SICK! (AND TIRED)



I feel like I've been hit by a car.

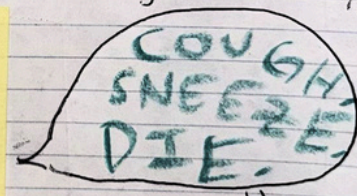


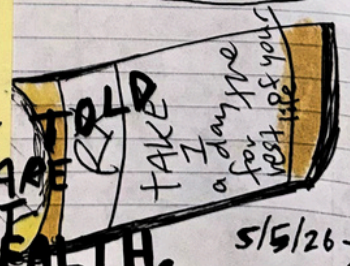
I don't think I've been this sick in my life. My throat is dry, my nose is dripping, and my head is pounding like it's trying to tell me, "rest". "Please rest.". But tell me, how am I supposed to rest when I have an exam worth my life, a professor who thinks I'm not worth his time, and a million other things more important than my health.



I Seriously can't tell if I'm sick because I'm coughing, or sick because I live in a world





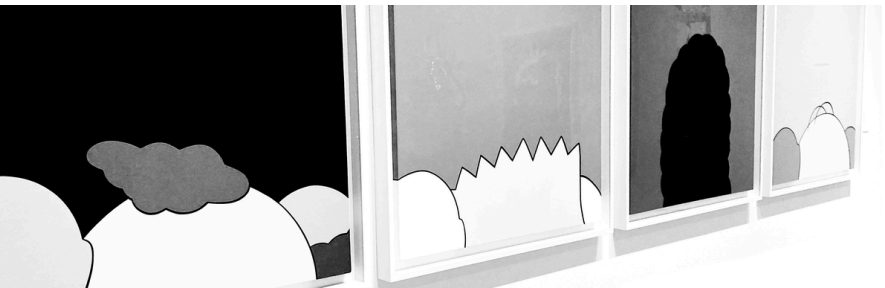


WHERE YOU ARE THAT THERE ARE MORE IMPORTANT THINGS THAN YOUR HEALTH.

5/5/26 - TOOTH





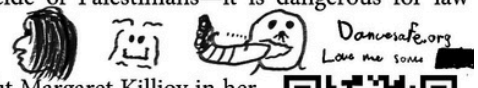




I was stumbling towards androgyny and came across a warning sign

Leaning too closely in one direction yields an unbecoming wraith. She who breaks through windows and circles the ocean's vast, inky drain, emerges bloodied and hungry. He who treads towards half-death with my hair billowed around his neck is no different from a bitch on a leash chasing its tail—fevered, pig-headed, and reckless. Beneath the daily scrutiny of street lamps, I tirelessly swim in jagged circles only to not make a complete shape with my splitting body. My blunt limbs slice through turbulence and earnestness and tattooed men and fluid women and metal-clad icons and bronzed deities and I still return, splitting. Do not mistake a splitting body for an undoing, it is a distorted meditation on polarity. The wraith is flesh I can't put my finger on, yet it its so deliciously flush on either side of a blade, as if it were meant to go there. The friction of its bite whittles away at my core until I snap, splintered and hallowed. Like a gorge with nectar running through it, cushioning fatality with divinity. I am marvelous and gutted, a fish with scales of pearl and fins of poison. Neither floating nor sinking. Splitting, with life rising out of me like smoke from a gun. This evening, the water in which I dwell will turn bitter, still, and ruddy under the stripping glare of a lamp post. The light spilling from above will posthumously realize me as a chimera of Venus, Mars, and Mercury.

I begin with a critique of this zine, specifically the submission process. We want this zine to be student-run, but the method by which we verify submissions are from students is using our University email. Google is the provider for University emails and thus knows exactly who submits what to this anonymous journal. The consequence is that my submission is not entirely anonymous, even if I don't attach my name to this document—Google knows who is writing this, which means anybody they choose to share this with, in particular law enforcement, also may know who is writing this if they so choose. In a time where free speech is being trampled on —specifically, student protests against the genocide of Palestinians—it is dangerous for law enforcement to know who speaks freely.



I would speak more directly on what I propose but Margaret Killjoy in her article "Into the Demiground" puts it better than I could: "This security method proposes imagining our lives (at least our digital lives) divided into three categories. The A life, the B life, and the C life. Your A life is your aboveground life, one that is easily traced and whose data is routinely fed into algorithmic tracking. This life leaves a huge digital footprint. Your C life is your underground life. It is meant to leave no footprint at all, and is the realm in which any actual crime you might want to commit (such as direct resistance to a fascist state) would take place. Your B life is your demiground life, where, under an authoritarian regime, most of your socializing and online life ought to probably take place. Here, you will leave some footprints, but not ones that are easily categorized and sorted by machines." You can scan the QR code to the right to read the whole thing.

Once you have done so, you might enjoy that Matrix, not the movie or the one referenced in the interesting, not entirely agreeable but worth reading article to the left in reference to the movie (which incidentally is an excellent portal to browsing using Onion routing, something as easy to do as downloading the Tor browser and clicking the magic onion link on thehiddenwiki) is an end-to-end encrypted chat protocol which, if you use the Element client, is reminiscent of Discord. You might in particular enjoy joining this Matrix Space I made for CCC, QR code to the right.



As you can tell from all these QR codes, I'm a big fan of the words of others. A few other sources I recommend: Watch Noam Chomsky's lectures on "The Political Economy of the Mass Media"; watch some Slavoj Žižek lectures; go to crimethinc.com and read the writings, print out zines, and so on. Lastly, go look up the Black Panther Party's reading list and if you can't afford physical copies, download many of the books for free off libgen, zlib, or Anna's Archive. Try Fanon first.

I end with the abridged version of "First they came" by Martin Niemöller, next to an entirely unrelated song I love, with little connection whatsoever to the anarchist politics I've espoused:

First they came for the socialists, and I did not speak out—
Because I was not a socialist.
Then they came for the trade unionists, and I did not speak out—
Because I was not a trade unionist.
Then they came for the Jews, and I did not speak out—
Because I was not a Jew.
Then they came for me—and there was no one left to speak for me.



Why are You in School?





As my graduation rapidly approaches, I've spent a lot of time reflecting on my 4 years at UCR. Entering university, I had no idea what I wanted to do. Stepping into this transitional period of self-discovery alone after moving across the state etched a newfound chip on my shoulder. I was emotionally immature and took my anger out on the world for my own inadequacies, isolating myself from friends, family, and new opportunities to meet others. I entered as CHASS undeclared, and it wasn't long before I transferred to pre-business as a Sophomore, then found my place in MCS in my Junior year (Media and Cultural Studies). For years, I was afraid to do what I wanted because of cultural, familial, and societal expectations. I felt it the most when transferring to MCS. It was as though I had to justify my decision to others, "Why would you pick that??" "What job will that get you?" and "Is that even a real degree?" Yes, finding work is incredibly important (especially in these trying times). But these questions have rarely come from a place of concern or interest, but rather as a roundabout slight born from the stigmatization of humanitarian degrees not fitting the mold of a traditional career in corporate America. **We have been conditioned to think that higher education is solely a means to an end for the highest pay and best jobs that fit the economy's immediate needs**. That's bullshit**.** Yes, historically, education has been one of the best avenues to climb the socioeconomic ladder. But it wasn't designed to do so. It was meant to foster learning, encouraging one to challenge their views and open their perspective toward new ideas. Doing so grows academia's ecosystem, birthing new ideas and uplifting those who seek to learn from it. Now, **a** bachelor's **degree has been reduced** to the same level as a high school diploma or GED: another requirement for an entry-level position for which you are now overqualified. The standards have lowered to fit this model. Though UCR will never air this publicly, I have been told by many **professors** throughout my college career that they **are encouraged not to fail students**, not because of how difficult the material is or the immense workload of the quarter system, but rather to feed into higher education's new economic model: churning out as many degrees as possible for as much as possible with the quickest return. I can tell you that professors know when students do not read their course material. When only a handful of people (if any) participate in discussions or lectures, they know. They know you're on your phone, watching TV in class, doom-scrolling, and quite frankly, not giving a shit. They overlook it because that's the environment that's encouraged. Even if they wanted to, **why push someone intellectually who doesn't choose to participate in the education they're paying for?** Many sit on their ass in class, scrape by, and collect their degree. But for what? What did you get out of it? Can you truly say you've learned anything? And can you say for certain that the piece of paper you now hold, in which you "earned," will help you compete in a job market geared to replacing people with automation? Our generation was brought up being told that higher education was the best option, if not the only one, for many. Now that I'm graduating, I can say I'm happy I picked MCS. I could never quantify the value of my education and the perspective now endowed upon me. I now know that the fallacy of higher education sold to us as children is not conducive to success. I hope that you find value in your degree because it means something to you, not because it will "get you a job."